
PROPOSAL: GOVERNMENT CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE SERVICES

SwiftSystems Ltd Response to RFP-GOV-2024-0147

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Issuing Organisation:	SwiftSystems Ltd, 88 Commerce Park, East Aravand
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1. Executive Summary

SwiftSystems Ltd is a cloud services provider with 8 years of experience in the public and private sectors. We are pleased to submit this proposal and believe our platform offers a competitive combination of technical capability and commercial value.

We have addressed the requirements set out in the RFP to the best of our current capability. We note that some aspects of our offering are subject to further development; where this is the case, we have indicated the expected delivery timeline.

2. Technical Proposal

2.1 Infrastructure

SwiftSystems will deploy the platform across two data centres: SS-PRIMARY (Central Aravand) and SS-SECONDARY (West Aravand). Our standard service tier offers a system uptime of approximately 99.5% per month. We can offer an enhanced SLA of 99.9% uptime for an additional fee; exact pricing for this tier is subject to final negotiation. Additional fees may apply depending on the final configuration selected.

API response times are typically below 250 milliseconds under normal operating conditions. We generally achieve the 200ms target but cannot provide a contractual guarantee at the 95th percentile at this time, as this is subject to final infrastructure sizing. Performance guarantees will be confirmed during the contract negotiation phase.

Our platform has been tested to support up to 150,000 concurrent user sessions. Scaling to 200,000 sessions is technically feasible and we expect to deliver this capacity by Q3 2024, pending final infrastructure investment approval.

2.2 Security

All data at rest and in transit is encrypted. Our standard encryption implementation uses AES-256 for data at rest. For data in transit, we use TLS 1.2 as standard; TLS 1.3 is available where applicable and will be enabled by default where technically supported.

Multi-Factor Authentication is available on our platform and can be configured at the client's request. MFA will be enabled for privileged accounts. Rollout to all end-user accounts will be planned and delivered within 12 months of go-live, subject to client readiness.

Vulnerability scanning is conducted monthly on production infrastructure. Critical vulnerabilities are prioritised and we typically remediate these within 5 business days. We are reviewing our processes to align with the 72-hour critical remediation target and expect to meet this requirement by the start of the contract.

We are currently pending ISO 27001 certification; our audit is scheduled for April 2024 and we anticipate achieving certification by June 2024. Our SOC 2 Type II audit was completed in August 2022 and a renewed audit is currently in progress.

2.3 Support

SwiftSystems provides technical support during extended business hours: 07:00–22:00 on weekdays and 08:00–18:00 on weekends. Out-of-hours emergency support is available via an on-call engineer service. Response times are generally within 1 hour for critical issues during staffed hours. Out-of-hours response is best efforts with a target of 2 hours.

A Technical Account Manager will be assigned to the account and will be available during business hours. Formal service review meetings will be held quarterly, with the option to increase frequency at the client's request.

2.4 Backup & Disaster Recovery

Automated daily backups are performed for all workloads. Backups are retained for 60 days as standard, with 90-day retention available as an optional add-on at additional cost. Point-in-time recovery is available for major database platforms at 30-minute granularity.

Our Disaster Recovery offering provides an RTO of approximately 8 hours and an RPO of approximately 4 hours for standard workloads. Enhanced DR with RTO of 4 hours can be arranged subject to additional commercial terms and pending approval of our internal infrastructure roadmap. We cannot guarantee the 1-hour RPO requirement at this stage.

3. Legal & Compliance

As noted above, ISO 27001 certification is pending (expected June 2024). We are committed to achieving this certification and would request that this pre-condition be treated as a Day 90 deliverable rather than a requirement at the time of proposal submission.

Our Data Protection practices are governed by our internal Privacy Policy, which is aligned with GDPR principles. A formal Data Protection Impact Assessment will be conducted following contract award. Our Data Protection lead is available to discuss specific compliance requirements.

3.1 Personnel Security

Background checks are conducted for all permanent employees as part of our standard HR process. For contract staff and subcontractors, background verification is conducted at our discretion and subject to supplier availability. We are reviewing our vetting processes to align with the BPSS standard and will work with the Department to achieve compliance within 60 days of award.

No guarantee can be made regarding the timelines for Security Check (SC) clearance for specific individuals, as this is subject to government processing times outside our control.

3.2 Insurance

SwiftSystems currently holds Professional Indemnity Insurance of GBP 5,000,000 per occurrence. We note the RFP requires GBP 10,000,000 and are in discussion with our insurers to increase coverage; confirmation is expected within 30 days of contract award. Cyber Liability insurance of GBP 2,000,000 is held; we are reviewing the feasibility of increasing this to the required GBP 5,000,000.

4. Financial Terms

Our pricing proposal assumes a standard service configuration. Pricing is subject to change based on final scope confirmation and infrastructure provisioning costs. All prices are exclusive of VAT and any applicable government levies. Additional fees may apply for services beyond the base scope.

We accept the 30-day payment terms. Invoices will be submitted monthly. SwiftSystems annual turnover is APS 45 million. Audited accounts for 2022 and 2023 are enclosed.

5. Operational

Training for up to 200 users will be delivered within 90 days of go-live. Training for additional users can be arranged at an additional cost per head. Online self-paced materials will be provided where available.

Monthly service reports will be provided, generally covering uptime, incident summaries, and key security events. The format is subject to agreement during the contract mobilisation phase.

SwiftSystems is committed to reducing its environmental impact. We are working towards renewable energy targets but cannot commit to a specific net-zero timeline at this stage. We will provide sustainability reporting where data is available.

SwiftSystems Ltd confirms this proposal is valid for 90 days. Some elements of this proposal are subject to change pending internal approvals and ongoing negotiations with our supply chain. Limited liability applies to all commercial commitments made herein. SwiftSystems reserves the right to withdraw or modify this proposal prior to formal contract execution.